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LILY HAY NEWMAN

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Security News This Week: AI Found a Root Bug in Linux That Everyone Missed for 15 Years

Plus: The Pentagon is training amateurs to become part of its hacker army, a Flock license plate reader error led to cops surrounding a car reviewer, and more.

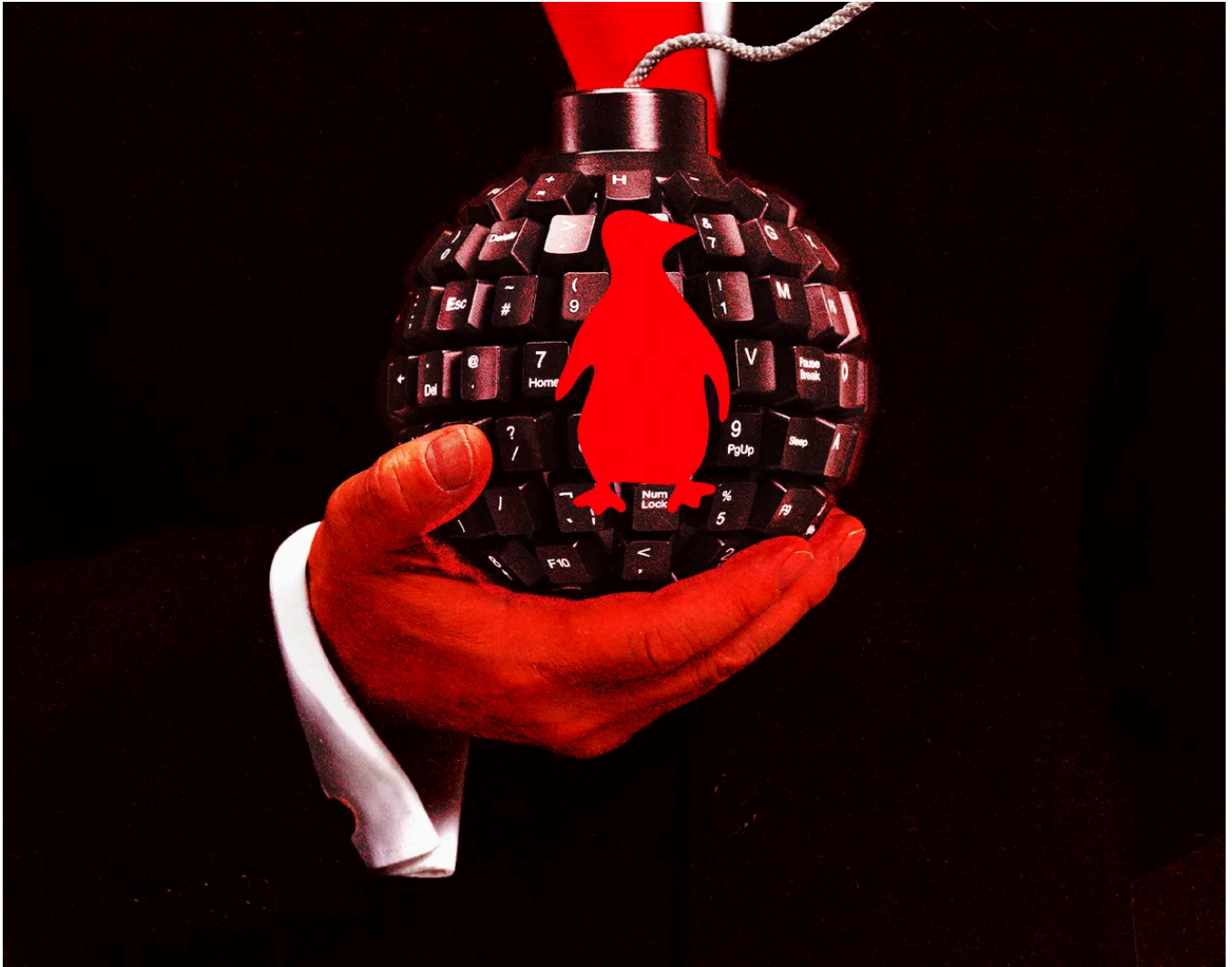


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SAVE THIS STORY

investigating online critics of the agency, opening more than 100 cases looking at what ICE officials call “incidents of doxing and threats” against agency employees. And in the European Union, tech companies will be able to scan citizens’ personal texts, emails, and social media messages again because of renewed powers in the “Chat Control” bill aimed at curbing online child abuse material. The European Parliament voted to extend the legislation despite a majority of lawmakers voting against the proposal.

WIRED revealed more about the Madison Square Garden surveillance landscape this week with revelations that MSG kept a database categorizing hundreds of celebrities, prominent Knicks superfans, and even some Taylor Swift wedding guests using labels that included “LGBTQIA,” “DO NOT HOST,” and low to high “risk.”

And new research this week shows that a wave of government website hijacks in which scammers promise “leaked” OnlyFans content are being stymied by thousands of copyright complaints from adult content creators, helping keep people safe by getting the malicious links taken down.

And there’s more. Each week, we round up the security and privacy news we didn’t cover in depth ourselves. Click the headlines to read the full stories. And stay safe out there.

AI Found a Root Bug in Linux That Everyone Missed for 15 Years

Nebula Security has published exploit code for GhostLock (CVE-2026-43499), a use-after-free bug that sat in the Linux kernel for 15 years and lets any logged-in

22.04, and 20.04 LTS as vulnerable or in progress, so defenders should confirm the fixed package rather than assume one is waiting.

Notably, Nebula found the bug with VEGA, its AI-driven bug-hunting tool, part of a 2026 run of Linux privilege-escalation flaws surfaced by automated tools combing old kernel code few had reread in years.

Flock Cameras Sent 4 Cops After a Reporter

Writing in The Drive, reporter Joel Feder describes being boxed in by four Plymouth, Minnesota, police cars in a Kohl's parking lot in late June—officers shouting, hands on their guns—because Flock's license plate cameras had flagged the \$155,000 Range Rover he was testing, loaned from a New Jersey dealership, as stolen. Feder writes that police had been tracking the SUV around town for days ... because of a typo.

The cause traced back to a data-entry error 2,000 miles away: a Jaguar Land Rover fleet plate reading 34 03 DTM had been reported to Los Angeles police as lost, but it was entered into the system as just “34 DTM”—dropping the smaller middle digits that New Jersey uses on manufacturer plates. Flock's cameras read the large characters, ignored the nonstandard structure, and started alerting police to any matching car. Feder reports that four other Land Rovers sharing the same license plate format were being tracked around Minnesota that same week; he was just the first pulled over.

The plate that kicked off all this police activity turned out not to have been stolen at all, just misplaced during a photo shoot. Ironically, the incident came barely

Consulting giant Accenture has confirmed a security breach after a threat actor going by “888” claimed to have lifted 35 GB of data—source code, RSA and SSH keys, Azure access tokens, and configuration files—and put it up for sale on a cybercrime forum, [according to BleepingComputer](#). Accenture called it an “isolated matter,” said it had remediated the source, and reported no impact to operations but declined at the time to comment on what was actually taken or how the attackers got in. To back the claim, 888 posted a screenshot appearing to show a cloned Azure DevOps repository on a redacted Accenture.com host; BleepingComputer couldn't verify the full scope. It's not the actor's first swing at the company—888 tried to sell Accenture employee data after a third-party breach in 2024, and Accenture separately got hit by LockBit ransomware in 2021.

The timing of the breach is particularly awkward: Accenture's federal arm has held [ICE's Cyber Defense and Intelligence Support Services contract](#)—24/7 threat monitoring, intrusion detection, and incident response across the agency's networks—since September 2021, a roughly \$56.5 million task order that expires at the end of August and is currently being recompeted.

The Pentagon Wants to Train an Army of Amateur Hackers—but Not for a Living Wage

The Pentagon opened applications this week for Cyber RAP, a paid apprenticeship that recruits people with no cyber degree or experience—just the aptitude to learn—into 12-month, full-time gigs learning to guard the department's networks, [according to DefenseScoop](#). The US military's CIO, Kirsten Davies, pitched it as ditching “academic gatekeeping” for “raw aptitude, patriotic drive, and hands-on capability.” But the pay is an abysmal \$22,584 a year, and those who wash out will owe the government back for the training.

Critics see a line being crossed. Nick Leiserson, a former Biden White House cyber official, said the hack-for-hire plan “contributes to global cyber instability” and noted the US has sanctioned Chinese contractors for doing the same thing.

The idea has a colorful pedigree. Last year, US representative David Schweikert of Arizona introduced the Scam Farms Marque and Reprisal Authorization Act, which would let the president issue “letters of marque and reprisal”—the same instrument the US last handed to privateers in the War of 1812—authorizing private operators to seize the assets of foreign cybercriminals, including crypto wallets tied to scams against Americans, [as The Register reported](#). The bill went to committee and never got a vote.

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Lily Hay Newman is a senior writer at WIRED focused on information security, digital privacy, and hacking. She previously worked as a technology reporter at Slate, and was the staff writer for Future Tense, a publication and partnership between Slate, the New America Foundation, and Arizona State University. Her work ... [Read More](#)

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What Happens if China Hacks the US Water Supply? I Went to a Secret War Game to Find Out

Burst water mains. Evacuated hospitals. In a closed-door simulation, insurers played out their response to a mass disruption by China's Volt Typhoon hackers—and found a nightmare scenario.

ANDY GREENBERG

EU Politicians Investigated Pegasus Spyware. Then It Ended Up on One of Their Phones

“It is a direct attack on the rule of law,” says one European Parliament member of the new findings from Citizen Lab.

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OpenAI Launches Full-Scale Effort to Patch Open-Source Bugs as It Takes on Anthropic's Mythos

Amid concerns about AI models' cybersecurity capabilities, OpenAI revealed an improved version of GPT-5.5-Cyber and its "Patch the Planet" initiative to fix open-source software bugs.

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Apple's Hide My Email Service Fails to Hide Your Email

Plus: Alleged Scattered Spider hacking member extradited, dozens of license plate reader errors, and Indian officials are concerned about WhatsApp's username rollout.

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World Cup Scams Are Getting Harder to Spot

From fake tickets to cloned websites, AI is magnifying World Cup scams. Can fans distinguish between what's real and what's not?

JUMANA NAIM

OnlyFans Models Are Accidentally Making Hacked Government Websites Disappear

Scammers are hijacking government websites to upload ads for “leaked” OnlyFans content. Thousands of copyright complaints from adult creators are helping people avoid malicious links.

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Meta Pauses Employee-Tracking Program Following Internal Data Leak

The move comes after the company left potentially sensitive data from the initiative exposed internally.

PARESH DAVE

